But after having engineered the massive famine can you imagine the aid he gave to the survivors? We are told that corpses piled up all along the highways as millions marched looking for the food. Fathers looked for opportunities to sell their sons as slaves, hoping they find some nourishment, but such was the wrath of famine that there were no takers. The mothers along with their daughters drowned in the rivers.

Shah Jahan distributed a famine relief fund of Rs 1 lakh which was merely 2 per cent of what he had gifted Mumtaz on the eve of Nauroz. The annual maintenance of Mumtaz was Rs 1 crore and his imperial treasury had sum of Rs 6 crore in cash. The famous Peacock Throne on which he sat was valued to be around Rs 3 crores in that period.

Angus Madison gives us some interesting records.[*]

The total expense of the Tīmūrid (distorted as Moghūls) State, and associated autonomous princelings and chiefs was anything between 15-18 per cent of the national income.

He estimates that around twenty-one million people (out of a total population of approximately 150 million) constituted the predatory Tīmūrid (distorted as Mughal) ecosystem—the court, family, army, harems, servants, slaves, and eunuchs who produced nothing and only consumed.

He writes, ‘As far as the economy was concerned, the Moghūl state apparatus was parasitic.’ According to him, the state was a regime of warlord predators which was lesser efficient than European feudalism.

He further writes, ‘The Moghūl state and aristocracy put their income were largely unproductive. Their investments were made in two main forms: hoarding precious metals and jewels.’

Bharat had always been primarily agrarian in nature and the Tīmūrid Empire systematically destroyed it. American Historian J.F. Richards writes in his work *Fiscal States in Mughal and British India*:[†]

> The Mughal dynasty’s wealth and power was based upon its ability to tap directly into the agrarian productivity of the Indian sub-continent.
>
> Trade, manufacture and other taxes were much less important to the imperial revenues than agriculture, most estimates putting them at less than 10% of the total.

Let us again come back to the writings of Bernier:[*]

> Of the vast tracts of country constituting the empire of Hindoustan, many are little more than sand, or barren mountains, badly cultivated and thinly peopled; and even a considerable portion of the good land remains untilled from want of labourers; many of whom perish in consequence of the bad treatment they experience from the Governors.